

INFORMATION TO USERS

This dissertation was produced from a microfilm copy of the original document. While the most advanced technological means to photograph and reproduce this document have been used, the quality is heavily dependent upon the quality of the original submitted.

The following explanation of techniques is provided to help you understand markings or patterns which may appear on this reproduction.

1. The sign or "target" for pages apparently lacking from the document photographed is "Missing Page(s)". If it was possible to obtain the missing page(s) or section, they are spliced into the film along with adjacent pages. This may have necessitated cutting thru an image and duplicating adjacent pages to insure you complete continuity.
2. When an image on the film is obliterated with a large round black mark, it is an indication that the photographer suspected that the copy may have moved during exposure and thus cause a blurred image. You will find a good image of the page in the adjacent frame.
3. When a map, drawing or chart, etc., was part of the material being photographed the photographer followed a definite method in "sectioning" the material. It is customary to begin photoing at the upper left hand corner of a large sheet and to continue photoing from left to right in equal sections with a small overlap. If necessary, sectioning is continued again — beginning below the first row and continuing on until complete.
4. The majority of users indicate that the textual content is of greatest value, however, a somewhat higher quality reproduction could be made from "photographs" if essential to the understanding of the dissertation. Silver prints of "photographs" may be ordered at additional charge by writing the Order Department, giving the catalog number, title, author and specific pages you wish reproduced.

University Microfilms

300 North Zeeb Road
Ann Arbor, Michigan 48106
A Xerox Education Company

72-20,903

YUH, Liou-yi, 1944-

LIU YUNG, SU SHIH, AND SOME ASPECTS OF THE
DEVELOPMENT OF EARLY TZ'U POETRY.

University of Washington, Ph.D., 1972
Language and Literature, classical

University Microfilms, A XEROX Company, Ann Arbor, Michigan

LIU YUNG, SU SHIH, AND SOME ASPECTS OF THE
DEVELOPMENT OF EARLY TZ'U POETRY

by

LIU-YI YUH

A dissertation submitted in partial fulfillment
of the requirements for the degree of

DOCTOR OF PHILOSOPHY

UNIVERSITY OF WASHINGTON

1972

Approved by Wm. Y. C. Shih
(Chairman of Supervisory Committee)

Department ASIAN LANGUAGES AND LITERATURE
(Departmental Faculty sponsoring candidate)

Date March 3, 1972

UNIVERSITY OF WASHINGTON

Date: February 17, 1972

We have carefully read the dissertation entitled LIU YUNG, SU SHIH AND SOME ASPECTS OF THE DEVELOPMENT OF EARLY TZ'U POETRY submitted by Liou-yi Yuh in partial fulfillment of the requirements of the degree of Doctor of Philosophy and recommend its acceptance. In support of this recommendation we present the following joint statement of evaluation to be filed with the dissertation.

Miss Liou-yi Yuh has succeeded in what she set out to do, that is to evaluate the contribution of two major tz'u writers of the northern Sung dynasty and placed them in their niches in the development of tz'u poetry. She has convincingly demonstrated that while Liu Yung, still mainly concerned with love as his subject, has in his treatment considerably more psychological depth, emotional intensity and individuality, and the use of longer tunes; Su Shih's innovation is in the area of subject matter, broadening the scope of tz'u to include almost anything. Although her quantitative approach, much in vogue now, may not be what we would have recommended, in view of the fact that she has profitably used the results of her statistical method, we recommend that her dissertation be accepted as partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of Doctor of Philosophy.

DISSERTATION READING COMMITTEE:

Vernon M. Rieck, Chairman

He Dan

Isabella Yeh

PLEASE NOTE:

Some pages may have

indistinct print.

Filmed as received.

University Microfilms, A Xerox Education Company

Doctoral Dissertation

In presenting this dissertation in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the doctoral degree at the University of Washington, I agree that the Library shall make its copies freely available for inspection. I further agree that extensive copying of this dissertation is allowable only for scholarly purposes. Requests for copying or reproduction of this dissertation may be referred to University Microfilms, 300 North Zeeb Road, Ann Arbor, Michigan 48106, to whom the author has granted "the right to reproduce and sell (a) copies of the manuscript in microform and/or (b) printed copies of the manuscript made from microform."

Signature Lion-yi Yuh

Date March 3, 1972

TABLE OF CONTENTS

	Page
INTRODUCTION.....	1
Chapter	
I. GENERAL FEATURES OF THE <u>TZ'U</u> POETRY OF THE T'ANG AND FIVE DYNASTIES.....	19
II. GENERAL FEATURES OF THE <u>TZ'U</u> POETRY OF THE EARLY SUNG DYNASTY.....	71
III. THE <u>TZ'U</u> POETRY OF LIU YUNG.....	125
IV. THE <u>TZ'U</u> POETRY OF SU SHIH.....	182
RECAPITULATION.....	280
BIBLIOGRAPHY.....	296

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

I would like to take this opportunity to thank Professors Hellmut Wilhelm and Vincent Shih who in turn directed this dissertation. Professor Wilhelm gave me invaluable help in the initial planning and in the revision of my first draft. When he retired, upon Professor Shih devolved the difficult task of directing a dissertation that was nearly complete. He proved more than equal to the occasion, however, and gave me much help even under the pressure of time.

I would also like to thank my two other readers, Professors Isabella Yen and Dao-lin Hsu; Professors Adele Rickett and W. Aliyn Rickett of the University of Pennsylvania read parts of the draft. Professors Chang Ching and Cheng Ch'ien of National Taiwan University helped with the interpretation of some of the poems.

To write a dissertation when three thousand miles distant from one's department can be awkward in innumerable ways. All difficulties vanished for me, however, due to the labor and initiative of Mrs. Audrey Epp, secretary to the Department, to whom I am deeply grateful.

Lastly, my sincere thanks go to Mr. Vincent A. Wald of Temple University who helped throughout in every way.

Introduction

I. Definition of tz'u 詞

The tz'u is a musico-poetic form evolved during the T'ang Dynasty. It flourished throughout the Sung, was replaced by the ch'ü 曲 in popularity after Sung times, but enjoyed a spectacular revival in the Ch'ing Dynasty. As a poetic form¹ it was less respectable than the shih 詩 at first but became fully acceptable around the twelfth century. A few scholars have attempted to define tz'u formally; one will suffice here: 'The tz'u is a song-form characterized by lines of unequal length, prescribed rhyme and tonal sequences, occurring in a large number of variant patterns, each of which bears the name of a musical air.'²

¹Tz'u was very closely related to music in the beginning stage, but came to be used more or less as a poetic form in Sung times. After Sung times the scores were lost and tz'u became a purely literary genre.

²J.R. Hightower, Topics in Chinese Literature (Cambridge: Harvard U. Pr., 1965), p. 90. Mr. Hightower's definition is often quoted. See G.W. Baxter, 'Metrical Origins of the Tz'u' in J.L. Bishop (ed.), Studies in Chinese Literature (Cambridge: Harvard U. Pr., 1965), p. 186; A.A. Rickett, 'Wang Kuo-wei's Jen-chien Tz'u-hua, A Study in Chinese Literary Criticism,' unpubl. diss. (Pennsylvania, 1967), p. 32. Ch'en Shou-yi gave a definition almost in the same words in his Chinese Literature, a Historical Introduction (Ronald Pr. Co., 1961), p. 340. Other definitions are to be found in Hsia Ch'eng-t'ao 夏承燾 and Wu Hsiung-ho 吳熊和, Tsen-yang tu T'ang Sung tz'u 怎樣讀唐宋詞 [How to Read Tz'u of T'ang and Sung] (Hangchow: Che-chiang jen-min ch'u-pan-she, 1958), p. 3, Hu Yün-i 胡雲翼, Sung-tz'u yen-chiu 宋詞研究 [A

II. The purpose of this study

There have been a few general studies of tz'u in Chinese, English and French; the important ones I have included in my bibliography. However, these scholars gave primarily historical surveys consisting of brief biographical sketches of individual poets, short, general discussions of the features of a given poet's tz'u, and translations or quotes of a few poems to illustrate theme, style and general literary merits. Such studies, due to the number of poets and length of time covered, remain on the plane of generalities and seldom go beyond pointing out a poet's favorite themes and poetic school.

The Sung poets Liu Yung 柳永 (985?-1053) and Su Shih 蘇軾 (1036-1101) each made a unique and lasting contribution to the development of the tz'u.³ In the following study I wish to trace four aspects of the development of tz'u from the T'ang and Five Dynasties through the tz'u of Liu Yung and Su Shih. The approach is historical as well as quantitative. The four aspects chosen are the tunes, themes, modes of discourse, and vocabulary and rhetoric. The study consists of

Study of Sung Tz'u] (Shanghai: Chung-hua shu-chū, 1927), pp. 16-17, Wang Li 王力, Han-yü shih-lü hsüeh 漢語詩律學 [Chinese Prosody] (Shanghai: Shang-hai chiao-yü ch'u-p'an-she, 1962), p. 509, and Hu P'in-ch'ing 胡品清, 'Sung Tz'u,' Wen-hsüeh hui-k'an 文學彙刊, Vol. 1 (1969), 119.

³After the draft of my dissertation was finished, an article on Liu Yung's tz'u by James Liu appeared in the Tamkang Review, Vol. II, No. 2 (1970), 1-44.

two parts. In the first part, i.e., chapters one and two, I give a brief account of the general features of early tz'u. In the second part, i.e., chapters three and four, I build on this historical base an evaluation of the innovations and peculiarities of Liu Yung's and Su Shih's tz'u.

III. Materials

It may be best at the outset to delineate precisely the corpus of poems with which my study will be concerned. Beginning with 1907 at Tun-huang manuscripts of early tz'u were recovered which shed new light on the origin and early stage of tz'u. I did not analyze these lyrics for two reasons. There is an excellent and thorough study of this body of poetry by an authority in the field, Jen Erh-pei. The result of his study is readily available in his Tun-huang ch'ü ch'u-t'an 敦煌曲初探 [Preliminary Research on the Songs from Tun-huang]. The lyrics recovered from Tun-huang have many textual problems: missing characters and lines, miswritten characters, etc. and thus are not suited to the same kind of analysis as the well preserved tz'u.

The T'ang and Five Dynasties period includes poets represented in the Tsun-ch'ien chi 尊前集 [A Collection from before the Wine-cups] and Hua-chien chi 花間集 [A Collection from among Flowers] as well as the group known as Southern T'ang poets.⁴ The twenty-one poets represented in the Tsun-

⁴Those poets who are represented in the Hua-chien chi or

ch'ien chi are:

- Hsüan-tsung of T'ang 唐玄宗 (685-762)
 Chao-tsung of T'ang 唐昭宗 (867-904)
 Chuang-tsung of Hou-T'ang 後唐莊宗 (892-926)
 Li Po 李白 (701-762)
 Wei Ying-wu 韋應物 (735?-835?)
 Wang Chien 王建 (751?-835?)
 Tu Mu 杜牧 (803-852)
 Liu Yü-hsi 劉禹錫 (772-842)
 Po Chü-i 白居易 (772-846)
 Lu Chen 盧貞 (fl. c. 836)
 Chang Chih-ho 張志和 (fl. c. 780)
 Ssu-k'ung T'u 司空圖 (837-908)
 Han Wo 韓偓 (fl. c. 901)
 Hsüeh Neng 薛能 (?-880)
 Ch'eng Wen-kan 成文幹 (fl. c. 960)
 Yü Ch'uan-su 庾傳素 (dates unknown; T'ang)⁵
 Liu Ssu-tu 劉侍讀 (dates unknown; T'ang)
 Ou-yang Pin 歐陽彬 (fl. c. 932)
 Hsü Min 許岷 (dates unknown; T'ang)

belong to the Southern T'ang group have been eliminated from the Tsun-ch'ien chi.

⁵This poet as well as the other three poets with unknown dates are to be found in Takeo Hiraoka 平岡武夫 and Kōkichi Ichihara's 市原亨吉 Tōdai no shijin 唐代の詩人 (T'ang Poets), T'ang Civilization Reference Series, IV (Jimbunkagaku kenkyū-sho, Kyoto U., 1960).

Lin Ch'u-ch'iao 林楚翹 (dates unknown; T'ang)

Hsü Ch'ang-t'u 徐昌圖 (fl. c. 965)

The Hua-chien chi represents eighteen poets:

Wen T'ing-yün 溫庭筠 (812?-870?)

Huang-fu Sung 皇甫松 (fl. c. 859)

Wei Chuang 韋莊 (836-910)

Hsüeh Chao-yün 薛昭蘊 (fl. c. 932)

Niu Chiao 牛嶠 (fl. c. 890)

Chang Pi 張泌 (fl. c. 924)

Mao Wen-hsi 毛文錫 (fl. c. 913)

Niu Hsi-chi 牛希濟 (fl. c. 913)

Ou-yang Chiung 歐陽炯 (896-971)

Ho Ning 和凝 (898-955)

Ku Hsiung 顧覓 (fl. c. 928)

Sun Kuang-hsien 孫光憲 (d. 968)

Wei Ch'eng-pan 魏承班 (fl. c. 930)

Lu Ch'ien-i 鹿虔扈 (fl. c. 913)

Yen Hsüan 閻選 (fl. c. 932)

Yin O 尹鶚 (fl. c. 896)

Mao Hsi-chen 毛熙震 (fl. c. 947)

Li Hsün 李珣 (855?-930?)

The Southern T'ang poets are:

Li Ching 李璟 (916-961)

Li Yü 李煜 (937-978)

Feng Yen-ssu 馮延巳 (903-960)⁶

Hsü Hsüan 徐鉉 (916-991)

In total there are forty-three poets who wrote 841 poems.

Chapter one deals with this body of tz'u.

In the early Sung period my study covers four major figures: Yen Shu 晏殊 (991-1055), Chang Hsien 張先 (990-1078), Ou-yang Hsiu 歐陽修 (1007-1072),⁷ and Yen Chi-tao 晏幾道 (1030-1106?). Except for Yen Chi-tao these poets were writing tz'u at the first half of the eleventh century and were thus Liu Yung's contemporaries. Yen Chi-tao came on the scene later and was a contemporary of Su Shih. These four poets together wrote 801 poems. Chapter two deals with their poetry.

Chapter three is devoted to Liu Yung who wrote 212 poems and chapter four to Su Shih who wrote 350 poems.

The earliest poet in the first period is Hsüan-tsung of T'ang, who lived from 685-762. Su Shih is the latest on in the whole group; he died in 1101.⁸ Thus, my study covers forty-

⁶ Hsia Ch'eng-t'ao thinks Yen-ssu is the correct version and gives his reasons for it. See his 'Feng Cheng-chung nien-p'u' 馮正中年譜 [A Chronological Table of Feng Cheng-chung] in his T'ang Sung tz'u-jen nien-p'u 唐宋詞人年譜 [Chronological Tables of Tz'u Poets of T'ang and Sung] (Peking: Chung-hua shu-chü, 1961), p. 35.

⁷ The tz'u poems in Ou-yang Hsiu's Tsui-weng ch'in-ch'ü wai-p'ien 醉翁琴趣外篇 [A Drunken Old Man's Careless Diversions on the Lute] are doubted by some as forgeries of Ou-yang's enemy. The whole controversy is settled by Tanaka Kenji 田中謙二 in his article 'Öyō Shū no shi ni tsuite' 歐陽修の

nine poets, 2204 poems and a period of roughly four hundred years. For text I used the Tsun-ch'ien chi in Chu T'su-mou's 朱祖謀 Ch'iang-ts'un ts'ung-shu 彊村叢書 [Works Collected by Ch'iang-ts'un], Hua Lien-p'u's 華連圃 Hua-chien chi chu 花間集注, Lin Ta-ch'un's 林大椿 T'ang wu-tai tz'u 唐五代詞 [Tz'u Poetry of T'ang and Five Dynasties] for the Southern T'ang poets. For the texts of the early Sung poets, Liu Yung and Su Shih I relied solely on T'ang Kuei-chang's 唐圭璋 Ch'üan Sung tz'u 全宋詞 [Complete Tz'u Poetry of Sung].

IV. Tools

I chose four aspects of tz'u for my field of investigation: their patterns, their themes, their modes of discourse, and their rhetoric and vocabulary. The method used in conducting this historical survey of early tz'u poetry is quantitative. It is an attempt to gather facts about this body of poetry, to seek generalizations and conclusions that are based more on facts than impressions.

Usually when a literary critic discusses the poetry of a certain period, he relies on two levels of impressions: his impressions of individual poems and his aggregate impression of the whole. Now, in remembering all the impressions of individual poems so as to arrive at the higher level of generali-

詞について [About Ou-yang Hsiu's Tz'u], Toho Gaku, 7 (1953), 50-62.

⁸I chose Su Shih instead of Yen Chi-tao because Yen's death date is not known for sure.

ty, i.e., the impression of the whole, the critic's memory may deceive him. What oftentimes happens is that he remembers what he likes most and least, while the average poems sort of fade away. The statistical method is an attempt to overcome this problem. After noting the initial impressions of individual poems, the task of adding up these impressions is not left to faulty memory. On the contrary, the impression of the sum total is derived arithmetically. There remains, of course, the problem that in recording the initial impressions I am really recording my own interpretation of the poems. But all literary criticisms are subjective and interpretative in that sense; i.e., they are based on the particular critic's reading of a work or a poem. It is neither possible nor even desirable to eliminate this element of subjectivity.

After I finished the draft of this dissertation I was very happy to discover that two scholars in Chinese literature have used a statistical method in their recent scholarship: James Liu in his article on Liu Yung and Burton Watson in his discussion of nature images in T'ang poetry in his new book, Chinese Lyricism.⁹ There is, of course, a large and growing body of criticism in the western languages that exploits the greater precision of the statistical approach, often with the aid of electronic computers. At the current (1971) MLA con-

⁹James Liu's article was mentioned earlier (footnote 3). For Watson's discussion see Chinese Lyricism: Shih Poetry from the Second to the Twelfth Century with Translations (New York: Columbia U. Pr., 1971), pp. 122-37.

vention, there is a seminar under the direction of Herbert S. Donow of Southern Illinois University on 'The Application of Computers to the Study of Language and Literature.'

A. Patterns

The information sought about patterns is: how many poets of a period have used a given pattern, how many poems are written to it, its metrical scheme, i.e., line lengths, whether the pattern is a standard one or a variant,¹⁰ whether it is a new creation, and the length or the total number of characters of the pattern. The purpose of gathering such information is to have a clearer picture of the history of the patterns which in turn will help my evaluation of Liu Yung's and Su Shih's use of patterns.

In discussing the length of a pattern I use the terms hsiao-ling 小令, chung-tiao 中調, and ch'ang-tiao 長調 as defined by Mao Hsien-shu 毛先舒 (1620-1688). A poem under 58 characters is a hsiao-ling, a poem between 59 and 90 characters is a chung-tiao and a poem over 91 characters is a ch'ang-tiao.¹¹ Many people have objected to this arbitra-

¹⁰I relied on the Ch'in-ting tz'u-p'u 欽定詞譜 (The Imperial Register of Tz'u Prosody), compiled by Wang I-ch'ing 王奕清 and others, and Lin Ta-ch'un's Tz'u shih 詞式 [Patterns of Tz'u] (Shanghai: Commercial Pr., 1934) for information on new tunes and standard patterns. The word 'variant' is used in a special sense. A variant is a poem the total number of characters and the metrical scheme of which differ from those of the standard pattern.

¹¹See Hsia Ch'eng-t'ao and Wu Hsiung-ho, Tsen-yang tu T'ang Sung tz'u, p. 20.

ry classification. Cheng Ch'ien 鄭騫 offered as an alternative: '...poems under seventy or eighty characters are hsiao-ling; poems over eighty or ninety characters are ch'ang-tiao.'¹² I find Cheng's criteria harder to apply because of the imprecision.

B. Themes

Hu Yün-i in his Sung-tz'u yen-chiu discussed eleven thematic categories into which all Sung tz'u poetry falls.¹³

They are:

1. Yen-ch'ing tz'u 艷情詞 [erotic poems]. This category includes all poems that have to do with lover(s).

2. Kuei-ch'ing tz'u 閨情詞 [poems on women's feelings]. Poems of this category describe the state of mind of a woman or maiden when alone in her boudoir. Usually the heroine's lover or husband is away and her thoughts tend to center on the absent one, her own loneliness, or love.

3. Hsiang-ssu tz'u 鄉思詞 [poems on thoughts of home]. Poems of this category describe the emotions and thoughts of a traveller.

4. Ch'ou-pieh tz'u 愁別詞 [poems on separation]. All the aspects and effects of parting and separation are described here.

¹²Cheng Ch'ien, Ts'ung-shih tao-ch'ü 從詩到曲 [From Shih to Ch'ü] (Taipei: K'o-hsueh ch'u-pan-she, 1961), p.96.

¹³Hu Yün-i, Sung-tz'u yen-chiu, pp. 68-70.

5. Tao-wang tz'u 悼亡詞 [lament on the dead]. Poems of this category deal especially with a dead wife.

6. T'an-shih tz'u 歎逝詞 [poems on the passage of time]. This category includes poems that touch on mutability, transience of life, impermanent happiness and loss of youth.

7. Hsieh-ching tz'u 寫景詞 [descriptive poems]. Here are descriptions of nature, objects in nature, particular scenes and sights. The meaning of the poems, however, often transcends the objects the poet is describing.

8. Yung-wu tz'u 詠物詞 [poems on things]. Poems of this category usually deal with objects in nature, such as flowers, trees, and natural phenomena, such as rain, snow. However, this category also includes poems on a variety of topics, objects, animate or inanimate things. Here, as in hsieh-ching poems, the significance of the poem often goes beyond the concrete things.

9. Chu-sung tz'u 祝頌詞 [eulogistic and congratulatory poems]. This category includes birthday congratulations and panegyrics.

10. Yung-huai tz'u 詠懷詞 [expression of feelings]. Poems of this category are personal expressions of thoughts, sentiments, aspirations, frustrations, etc.

11. Huai-ku tz'u 懷古詞 [poems on the past]. Poems of this category deal with nostalgia, past events, historical figures, famous spots, etc.

The categories yen-ch'ing, kuei-ch'ing, ch'ou-pieh, and tao-wang all deal with interpersonal relations in one way or another. The first two emphasize love between the sexes, the latter two center on the themes of separation and bereavement. The two categories hsieh-ching and yung-wu are just the opposite: they deal with anything but interpersonal relations. The categories hsiang-ssu, t'an-shih, yung-huai, and huai-ku are expressions of personal feelings and are essentially lyrical. However, in t'an-shih and huai-ku poems the time element is supreme; the tension frequently rests on the contrast between past and present. In hsiang-ssu poems the element of distance is supreme. Chu-sung poems, though expressing feelings, thoughts, and wishes, are primarily public utterances.

In studying the themes of the 2204 poems I looked for information on the themes of individual poems as well as the broad thematic categories to which they belong. I sought knowledge not only of the kind of things poets liked to write about but also of the general trends from period to period.

C. Modes of discourse

The term 'modes of discourse' refers to the ways a poet expresses what he wants to say. It is equivalent to the types of composition in prose: description, narration, argumentation and exposition, or the types of sentences: declarative, interrogative, imperative, and exclamatory. The modes of discourse I used to analyze the poems are: (1) descriptive, (2) narrative, (3) lyrical, (4) didactic, (5) imperative, (6) dis-

cursive, (7) dramatic monologue, and (8) direct discourse. The first three are very common and self-evident. The didactic mode aims at moral instruction. The imperative mode varies from a wish, an entreaty, to a command; special words are used to indicate the mode: 休 , 勿 , and 莫 for negatives, 願 and 須 for affirmatives. The discursive mode appeals to reason, usually indicating a reflective and philosophic mood. A dramatic monologue is a poem that consists of the speech of a single character. Direct discourse refers to the device of reporting snatches of conversation or someone's words. The difference between dramatic monologue and direct discourse is: in the former one person, i.e., the protagonist, speaks throughout the poem, which is necessarily a kind of first-person narrative; in the latter the speech reported forms only part of the poem and the speech can be an utterance of the protagonist, a second or even a third person.

Only a small number of poems, as I came to discover, are written in one mode from beginning to end. The majority of poems use a combination of two modes or more. This phenomenon will appear less strange after one takes a close look at the typical tz'u poem. Such a poem has usually three components: a setting, which can be any number of things: a woman's boudoir, a spring day in the country, a little garden, or the imperial palace; some kind of plot, usually very skeletal, say, the lover is far away; and a protagonist, who expresses his inner feelings either in speech or in action, such as

lamentations, exclamations, reproaches, weeping, looking into the distance, leaning on the railings, etc. The setting is static, provided by a description of the surroundings. The plot is revealed by a line or two of narrative, which forwards the action. The protagonist's feelings are revealed in subdued complaints or emotional outcries. A line or two of narrative takes care of his actions.

The study of the modes of discourse used by the poets aims at discovering whether there is any relationship between the length of a poem and the narrative mode, between themes and modes, the general preferences from period to period and the possible effect of modes on style.

D. Rhetoric and vocabulary

Rhetoric and vocabulary refers to various rhetorical devices and linguistic features, which I shall define briefly below.

1. Literal images: An image is a reproduction of a sensation produced by a physical perception. A literal image is one that requires no change or extension in the obvious meaning of the words and in which the words call up a sensory representation of the literal object or sensation.¹⁴

¹⁴The literal images that I found in the process of studying the poems turn out to be visual images. Sensations produced by physical perceptions other than sight are always an adjunct of a visual concrete object, for example, the sweet smell of incense. To facilitate discussion I divided the literal images into: personal images, such as lips, eyes, hair, skin, cosmetics, dress, ornaments, artificial images, such as objects

2. Allusion: An allusion is a tacit reference to a historical or literary figure, work or event.

3. Symbol: A symbol refers to a manner of representation in which what is shown, usually something concrete and material, means something more or something else, usually abstract and suggestive.

4. Simile and metaphor: A simile is an expressed comparison between two unlike objects, using like or as. We have a metaphor when two unlike objects are compared by identification or by the substitution of one for the other.

5. Synecdoche and metonymy: A synecdoche is a figure of speech in which a part is substituted for the whole or vice versa. A metonymy is a figure of speech in which the name of an attribute is substituted for that of the thing meant.

6. Pun: A pun is a play on words based on the similarity of sound between two words with different meanings.

7. Transferred epithet: A transferred epithet is an adjective used to limit a noun which it cannot logically modify.

8. Personification: It is a figure of speech that endows animals, ideas, inanimate objects with human form, qualities, or actions.

9. Onomatopoeia: The use of words that imitate sounds.

10. Colloquialism, refined language and prose diction: All

in a room, parts of a house, man-made things, and natural images, such as trees, flowers, the sun, the moon, and the elements.

three terms refer to linguistic features. A colloquialism is an expression used in informal conversation but not accepted as good usage in formal speech or writing. It lies between the upper speech level of literary language and the lower level of slang. Refined language is an extreme instance of the upper speech level of literary language, characterized by its formal tone and use of archaic expressions. Prose diction refers to the kind of language considered proper to prose.

The study of the rhetoric and vocabulary of tz'u poems is probably more important than that of any other aspect. A poet's style depends on the language and literary devices he employs. A detailed knowledge of the rhetorical and linguistic features of early tz'u poetry is indispensable to an accurate evaluation of Liu Yung's and Su Shih's tz'u poetry for such knowledge enables one to tell the novel from the conventional.

The following study is composed of four chapters and a short recapitulation. Each chapter is made up of two parts: first, a discussion of general characteristics of the body of poetry to which the chapter is devoted, and, second, explications of representative poems.

Poems are selected to demonstrate in a concrete way what I have said in the general discussion. After cataloguing and